

As global temperatures soar, wildfires are intensifying in scale and causing havoc

Climate change is not just a future threat — it is happening now. All signs indicate that it will cause severe **disruption** to both human lives and the planet. **One** of its latest **manifestations** **is** the increasing frequency of wildfires, **fueled** by dry weather and **soaring** temperatures, turning forests into **tinderboxes**. Recent **wildfires** in South Korea and California **serve** as **stark** reminders of the **escalating** threats **posed** by climate change. In March 2025, South Korea faced its worst wildfire disaster on record, with fires in North Gyeongsang Province **claiming** at least 28 lives, **displacing** over 37,000 people, and consuming more than 38,000 hectares of land. **Historic sites**, including the Gounsa Temple, **were** destroyed, and UNESCO World Heritage sites in Andong were **endangered**. Experts **attribute** the **severity** of these fires **to** ultra-dry conditions and strong winds, **exacerbated** by climate change.

Similarly, California has been **grappling with** increasingly **intense** wildfires. In 2024, the state experienced 8,024 wildfires, burning over one million acres, destroying 1,716 structures, and **resulting in** one **fatality**. **The Park Fire**, **ignited** in July 2024, **was** particularly **devastating**, consuming significant acreage and causing **widespread** damage. These events **underscore** the **harsh** reality of a warming planet. Climate change contributes to **prolonged droughts**, higher temperatures, and **altered precipitation** patterns, creating conditions **conducive to** wildfires. The increasing frequency and severity of these fires **highlight** the urgent need for comprehensive strategies to **mitigate** and **adapt** to climate change impacts.

Despite **mounting** evidence of climate change's devastating impact, some world leaders continue to **downplay** its significance. **Figures** like US President Donald Trump, who withdrew the US from the Paris Climate Agreement and **rolled back** environmental regulations, **have demonstrated** a lack of commitment to **addressing** this crisis. Their actions, or lack thereof, **hinder** global progress in mitigating climate change. The **wildfires** in South Korea and California **should** serve as a **wake-up call** for all global leaders. Governments must recognise that climate change is **playing havoc** with the lives of the people. **Policymakers** who dismiss scientific warnings or prioritise short — term **economic gains** over environmental **sustainability** **put** millions of lives and **ecosystems** at risk.

Back home, India is not **immune to** the growing threat of wildfires. **Regions** like Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh **have witnessed** forest fires, often exacerbated by rising temperatures and dry conditions. The recent **incidents** in South Korea and California **serve** as a wake-up call for India to **proactively address** this escalating risk. **Investing** in advanced technologies, such as satellite-based monitoring and artificial intelligence, **can aid** in the early detection of wildfires. California, **for instance**, is **deploying** AI — powered satellites to improve wildfire tracking and response. Besides, educating local communities about wildfire risks and promoting fire-safe practices can reduce human-induced **ignitions**. Establishing community-based fire management programs can enhance **resilience**.

Implementing sustainable forest management techniques, such as controlled burns and clearing of **flammable underbrush**, can reduce fuel loads and mitigate the spread of wildfires. But the **root causes** of climate change — **greenhouse gas emissions** **must** be **dealt with** first. **Transitioning** to renewable energy sources, enhancing energy efficiency, and promoting **afforestation** can contribute to long-term solutions. **Indeed** the countries must come together to **strengthen** international agreements like the Paris Climate Accord and **hold leaders accountable for** their environmental policies. Ignoring climate change will only lead to more **catastrophic** events, **endangering** lives, economies, and the planet itself. For India and the rest of the world, the time for **decisive** action is now.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Soar** (verb) – Rise, Surge, Escalate, Skyrocket, Ascend बढ़ना
2. **Intensify** (verb) – Escalate, Heighten, Amplify, Magnify, Aggravate तीव्र करना
3. **Scale** (noun) – Magnitude, Extent, Scope, Range, Proportion पैमाना
4. **Disruption** (noun) – Disturbance, Interruption, Upset, Disorder, Dislocation व्यवधान
5. **Manifestation** (noun) – Display, Demonstration, Expression, Indication, Sign प्रकटीकरण
6. **Fuel** (verb) – Feed, Stimulate, Provoke, Inflame, Sustain बढ़ावा देना
7. **Soaring** (adjective) – Rising, Increasing, Skyrocketing, Mounting, Spiraling तेजी से बढ़ता हुआ
8. **Tinderbox** (noun) – a thing that is readily ignited. आग का खतरा
9. **Stark** (adjective) – Harsh, Grim, Bleak, Severe, Blunt स्पष्ट
10. **Escalating** (adjective) – Increasing, Growing, Intensifying, Mounting, Rising बढ़ता हुआ
11. **Pose** (verb) – Present, Create, Cause, Constitute, Represent पेश करना
12. **Claim** (verb) – Take, Cause, Result in, Demand, Assert दावा करना
13. **Displace** (verb) – Uproot, Evict, Relocate, Remove, Oust विस्थापित करना
14. **Endanger** (verb) – Threaten, Jeopardize, Imperil, Risk, Hazard खतरे में डालना
15. **Attribute** (to) (verb) – Ascribe, Assign, Credit, Impute, Associate के लिए जिम्मेदार होना
16. **Severity** (noun) – Harshness, Intensity, Seriousness, Gravity, Acuteness गंभीरता
17. **Exacerbate** (verb) – Worsen, Aggravate, Intensify, Inflame, Compound बढ़ाना
18. **Grapple** (with) (verb) – Struggle, Wrestle, Combat, Tackle, Confront – से जूझना
19. **Intense** (adjective) – Extreme, Severe, Fierce, Powerful, Strong तीव्र
20. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Cause, Lead to, Bring about, Produce, Generate परिणाम होना
21. **Fatality** (noun) – Death, Casualty, Mortality, Loss, Demise मृत्यु
22. **Ignite** (verb) – Light, Kindle, Spark, Trigger, Inflame प्रज्वलित करना
23. **Devastating** (adjective) – Destructive, Ruinous, Catastrophic, Damaging, Harmful विनाशकारी

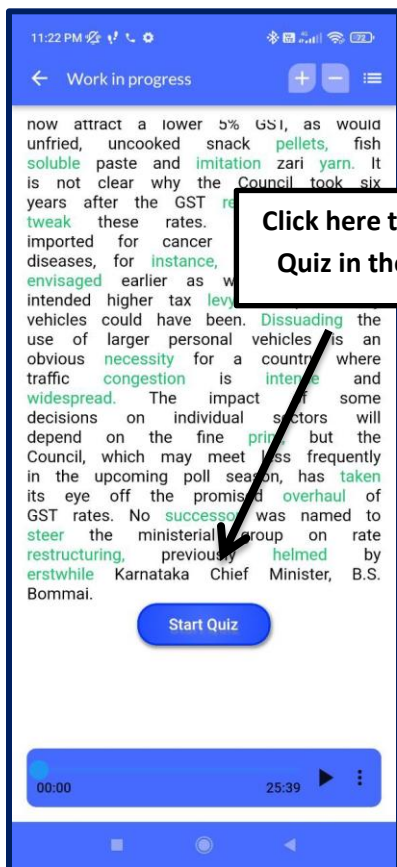
24. **Widespread** (adjective) – Extensive, Prevalent, Rampant, Universal, Farreaching व्यापक
25. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, Highlight, Stress, Accentuate, Underline जोर देना
26. **Harsh** (adjective) – Severe, Cruel, Brutal, Rough, Stern कठोर
27. **Prolonged** (adjective) – Extended, Lengthy, Protracted, Persistent, Drawnout लंबा
28. **Drought** (noun) – Dry spell, Aridity, Water shortage, Scarcity, Famine सूखा
29. **Alter** (verb) – Change, Modify, Adjust, Transform, Adapt बदलना
30. **Precipitation** (noun) – Rainfall, Rain, Snow, Hail, Sleet वर्षा
31. **Conducive** (to) (adjective) – Favorable, Suitable, Helpful, Beneficial, Advantageous अनुकूल
32. **Highlight** (verb) – Emphasize, Spotlight, Feature, Accentuate, Underscore जोर देना
33. **Mitigate** (verb) – Alleviate, Reduce, Lessen, Diminish, Relieve कम करना
34. **Adapt** (to) (verb) – Adjust, Acclimate, Accommodate, Familiarize, Conform अनुकूल बनाना
35. **Mounting** (adjective) – Increasing, Growing, Rising, Accumulating, Intensifying बढ़ता हुआ
36. **Downplay** (verb) – Minimize, Understate, Underestimate, Belittle, Diminish कम करके आंकना
37. **Roll back** (phrasal verb) – Reverse, Retreat, Withdraw, Cancel, Rescind वापस लेना
38. **Demonstrate** (verb) – Show, Exhibit, Display, Manifest, Prove प्रदर्शित करना
39. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, Handle, Confront, Deal with, Manage संबोधित करना
40. **Hinder** (verb) – Impede, Obstruct, Hamper, Block, Thwart सुलझाना, निपटाना
41. **Wakeup call** (phrase) – Warning, Alert, Alarm, Signal, Reminder चेतावनी
42. **Play havoc** (phrase) – Wreak havoc, Devastate, Ruin, Destroy, Damage तबाही मचाना
43. **Economic gain** (noun) – Profit, Benefit, Advantage, Earnings, Revenue आर्थिक लाभ
44. **Sustainability** (noun) – Durability, Continuity, Viability, Endurance, Maintenance स्थिरता
45. **Ecosystem** (noun) – Environment, Habitat, Biosphere, Ecological system पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र
46. **Back home** (phrase) – Domestically, In one's own country, Nationally, Locally अपने ही देश में

47. **Immune** (to) (adjective) – Resistant, Insusceptible, Protected, Invulnerable, Unaffected प्रतिरक्षित
48. **Witness** (verb) – Observe, See, Experience, Behold, View देखना
49. **Proactively** (adverb) Preventively, Actively, Anticipatorily, Preemptively, Ahead सक्रिय रूप से
50. **Aid** (verb) – Help, Assist, Support, Facilitate, Abet सहायता करना
51. **For instance** (phrase) – For example, Such as, Like, Namely, As an illustration उदाहरण के लिए
52. **Deploy** (verb) – Utilize, Employ, Dispatch, Position, Implement उपयोग करना
53. **Induce** (verb) – Cause, Bring about, Generate, Prompt, Stimulate उत्पन्न करना
54. **Ignition** (noun) – Lighting, Kindling, Sparking, Firing, Combustion प्रज्वलन
55. **Resilience** (noun) – Toughness, Endurance, Flexibility, Strength, Adaptability मजबूती
56. **Flammable** (adjective) – Combustible, Inflammable, Ignitable, Burnable, Fiery ज्वलनशील
57. **Underbrush** (noun) – Undergrowth, Brushwood, Shrubs, Bushes, Thicket झाड़ियाँ
58. **Greenhouse gas emission** (noun) – Carbon output, Pollution discharge, Climate pollutants ग्रीनहाउस गैस उत्सर्जन
59. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – Handle, Manage, Address, Tackle, Confront निपटना
60. **Transition** (verb) – Change, Shift, Convert, Transform, Move परिवर्तन करना
61. **Afforestation** (noun) – Reforestation, Tree planting, Woodland creation वनरोपण
62. **Indeed** (adverb) Truly, Certainly, Undoubtedly, Verily, Surely वास्तव में
63. **Strengthen** (verb) – Reinforce, Fortify, Bolster, Intensify, Enhance मजबूत करना
64. **Hold accountable for** (phrase) – Blame, Charge, Accuse, Attribute, Impute जिम्मेदार ठहराना
65. **Catastrophic** (adjective) – Disastrous, Devastating, Ruinous, Tragic, Calamitous विनाशकारी
66. **Decisive** (adjective) – Conclusive, Final, Definitive, Critical, Crucial निर्णायक

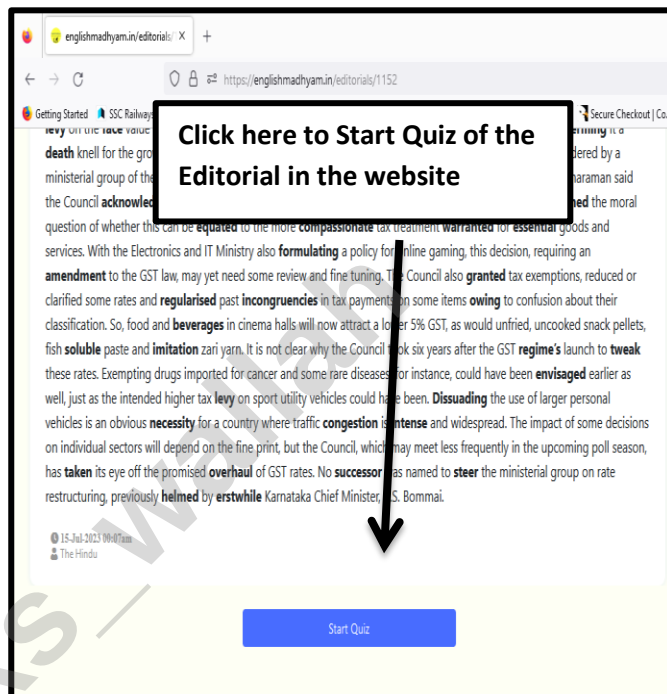
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Climate Change is a Present Crisis** – Rising global temperatures are not just a future threat but are already causing severe disruptions, including more frequent and intense wildfires.
2. **Wildfires Intensifying Globally** – Recent wildfires in South Korea (March 2025) and California (2024) highlight the devastating impact of climate change.
3. **South Korea's Record Wildfire Disaster** – Fires in North Gyeongsang killed 28, displaced 37,000, and burned 38,000 hectares, damaging historic sites like Gounsa Temple and threatening UNESCO heritage zones.
4. **California's Escalating Wildfires** – In 2024, over 8,000 fires burned a million acres, destroyed 1,716 structures, and caused fatalities, with the Park Fire being particularly destructive.
5. **Climate Change as a Catalyst** – Prolonged droughts, extreme heat, and altered rainfall patterns create ideal conditions for wildfires to spread rapidly.
6. **Political Denial Hinders Action** – Leaders like Donald Trump, who withdrew from the Paris Agreement and weakened environmental protections, delay crucial climate mitigation efforts.
7. **Need for Urgent Global Response** – Governments must acknowledge climate change as an immediate threat rather than dismissing scientific warnings for short-term economic gains.
8. **India Also at Risk** – States like Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh face increasing forest fires due to rising temperatures and dry conditions.
9. **Early Detection Technologies** – AI-powered satellite monitoring (as used in California) can help detect wildfires faster and improve response times.
10. **Community Awareness & Preparedness** – Educating locals on fire risks and safe practices can reduce human-induced fires, while community-based fire management programs enhance resilience.
11. **Sustainable Forest Management** – Controlled burns and clearing flammable underbrush can minimize wildfire fuel loads.
12. **Addressing Root Causes** – Reducing greenhouse gas emissions through renewable energy, energy efficiency, and afforestation is essential for long-term solutions.
13. **Stronger International Cooperation** – Countries must reinforce agreements like the Paris Accord and hold leaders accountable for climate policies.
14. **Economic & Ecological Consequences** – Ignoring climate change will lead to more disasters, threatening lives, economies, and ecosystems.
15. **Time for Decisive Action** – India and the world must act now to mitigate climate change and adapt to its growing impacts before wildfires and other disasters worsen.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



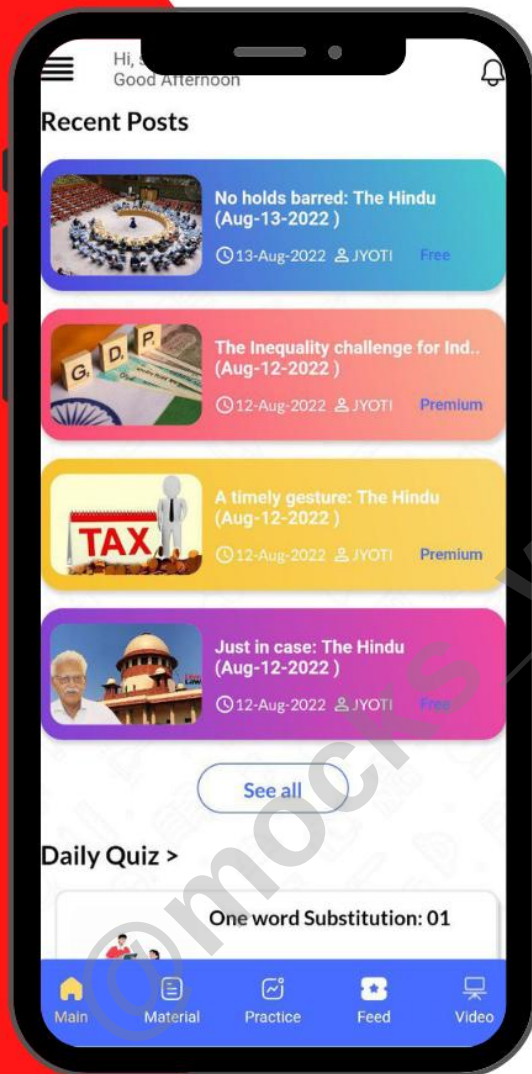
Click here to Start
Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the
Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam